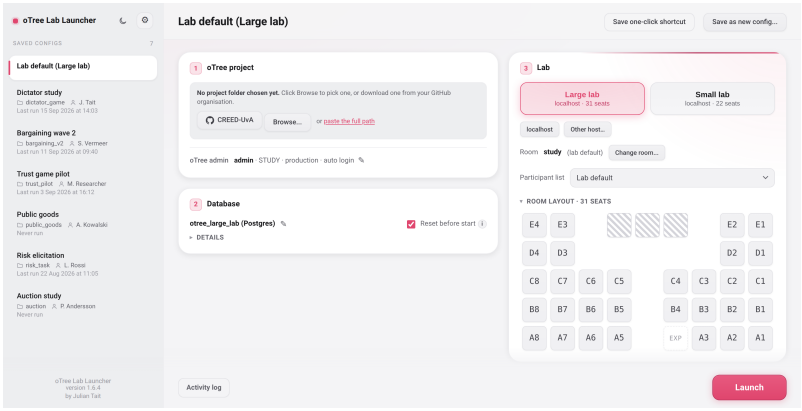
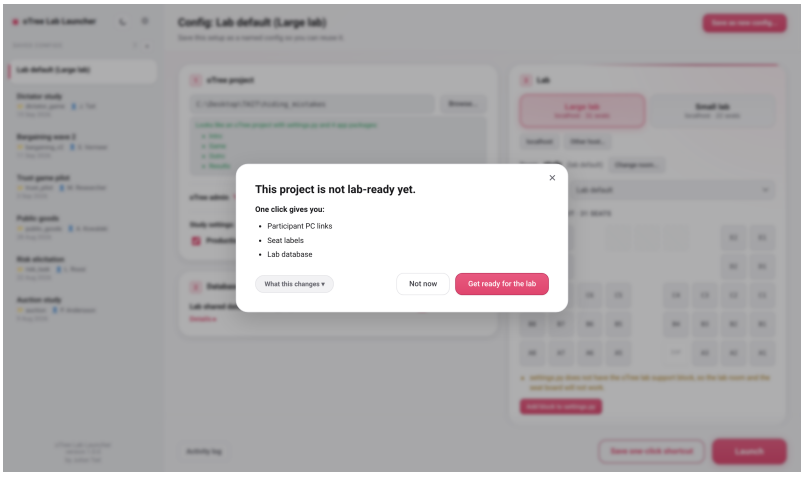
Run oTree studies **easily** with LabLauncher

Put your oTree project in a folder with your name on the lab computer or use *GitHub* (see below).

1. Double-click **Start oTree LabLauncher** on the desktop.
2. Click **Browse** and point it at your oTree study folder, or click the **CREED-UvA** GitHub button to download it from the lab organisation.



3. Get it **lab-ready**. In one step this wires up the shared lab database, the participant computer seat links, and the seat labels.



4. **Launch**. This starts the oTree server (default database).
5. **Join from the participant PCs**. On each participant PC, double-click the desktop shortcut for your lab: **oTree - Small Lab** or **oTree - Large Lab**.

   Optional: Save a one-click shortcut to the desktop for next time.

Using GitHub instead of a USB stick

1. **Put your study in the lab organisation.** If your experiment is a GitHub repository, add it to the lab organisation on GitHub, **CREED-UvA** (https://github.com/CREED-UvA). Ask the lab manager for access: they add you to the organisation or create the repository for you.
2. **Clone it on the lab computer.** Instead of copying the study over by USB stick, click the **GitHub** button in the LabLauncher, type (or pick) the repository name, choose your name as researcher, and click **Clone**. The study is saved locally on that computer and selected.
3. **It stays up to date.** Whenever you select the study, the launcher checks GitHub and offers **Update** if there are newer commits. The **Git Pull** button does the same by hand.
4. **Optional, one-time setup on your own computer.** To make every future `git push` also update the lab copy, run these two lines in your study folder:

   ```
   git remote set-url --add --push origin <your current repository URL>
   git remote set-url --add --push origin https://github.com/CREED-UvA/<your-study>.git
   ```

   The first line keeps pushing to your own repository: adding a push address replaces the default one, so your own address has to be added back first. After this, one `git push` updates both. Check with `git remote -v`, which lists two *(push)* lines.

Tips and troubleshooting

- **Running one session across both labs at once.** To pool the small and large lab into a single session, pick one computer to host the server, get ready as normal, and set the participant list to *None* before launching. When a participant list is selected, oTree only admits the seat labels that appear in it, so the other lab's seat labels are refused. With the participant list set to *None*, any label is accepted, so both labs can join the same session.